FND EDUCATION PROJECT

Meeting a person with FND

A one-page clinical orientation for an unfamiliar encounter

Listen to the person

Speak directly to the patient, even when a supporter is present. Ask what helps when speech, memory, movement or responsiveness is affected. Offer more time, another way to communicate, or a quieter setting when feasible. Invite supporter observations with permission.

Know what the diagnosis establishes

Functional neurological disorder (FND) involves genuine, involuntary symptoms. Diagnosis relies on relevant positive signs and clinical features, not normal tests alone or presumed psychological causes. A previously assessed functional event does not explain every future symptom.

Assess today on its merits

Compare the current presentation with the medically assessed pattern: what is familiar, changed or new? Consider injury, stability, coexisting conditions and relevant differentials. New focal deficits, serious injury, severe breathing difficulty or unexpected prolonged unresponsiveness warrant appropriate urgent assessment.

Make the response useful

An individual care plan can guide responses to familiar, assessed events. Match investigations and treatment to the current findings; avoid interventions without a clinical indication. Explain the reasoning clearly, accommodate access needs, and identify who will follow up. Practical OT, physiotherapy or speech-language input may help with daily safety.

What I would like the clinician to know

My symptoms, communication needs, other conditions or questions: